Errata

On Coppock, Green and Porter (2022), *Research & Politics* 9(1)

This note lists 18 errors in "Does digital advertising affect vote choice? Evidence from a randomized field experiment," published in *Research & Politics* 9(1), doi 10.1177/20531680221076901. **None of them changes a conclusion of the paper.** They are recorded because the published record is wrong and a reader who quoted it would be misled.

Entry 1 is a misstated number in the text. Entries 2 through 4 are errors in the appendix: two of labelling, one of a table printed in place of another. Entries 5 through 7 are errors the compositor introduced into Table 2. Entries 8 through 16 are errors in the reference list, nearly all of them introduced by the publisher's reference processing rather than by the authors, and each verified against the authoritative record at Crossref, and entries 17 and 18 are further errors in the reference list, found by reading the printed page rather than by the audit. Every corrected value in entries 1 to 4 is computed from the deposited replication archive (10.7910/DVN/UH2NQW) at the time this document is rendered. The maintained code is at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/coppock_green_porter_2022.

1. The unadjusted estimate is misstated by a factor of ten

Published, p. 4:

> …a **2.1 percentage point** increase in Democratic vote share, though this estimate is uncertain, as evidenced by its large **standard error of 3.0 percentage points**

Corrected:

> …a **0.2 percentage point** increase in Democratic vote share, though this estimate is uncertain, as evidenced by its large **standard error of 2.2 percentage points**

Table 4 reports 0.0021 with a standard error of 0.0225, which is 0.21 and 2.25 percentage points; the corrected sentence carries them at the one decimal the published sentence uses. The next sentence in the article applies percentage point units correctly to the adjusted estimate. The published standard error of 3.0 corresponds to no model in the paper or the

appendix. The claim the sentence makes is unaffected: on either reading the unadjusted estimate is small and swamped by its standard error, and the paper's conclusion rests on the covariate-adjusted estimate in column 2, which is reported and interpreted correctly throughout.

2. Figure G.2 names the wrong effect size

Published, panel annotation:

> Power when PATE = **0.1**

Corrected:

> Power when PATE = **0.01**

The simulated effects are drawn from a normal distribution centred at 0.01, which is what the appendix text says two paragraphs earlier. The label is a hardcoded string in the analysis script; nothing plotted is affected. The corrected figure:

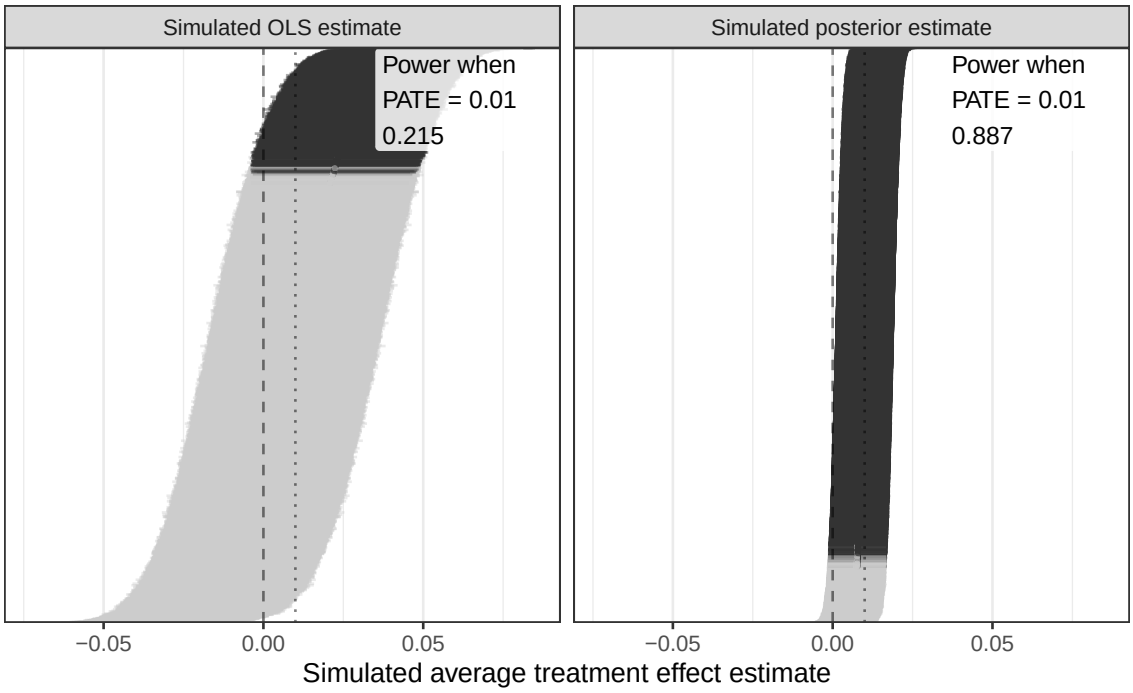


Figure G.2 (corrected)

Note: Figure G.2 as published, with the panel annotation corrected. Nothing plotted differs. Drawn from the deposited replication archive by `maintained/figure_g2_design_diagnosis.R`.

3. Covariate row labels are wrong in five appendix tables

No coefficient, standard error or summary statistic is affected: the estimates beside the wrong labels are the ones the caption describes. Both balance models regress the treatment indicator on lagged two-party vote margins, not shares. No ZIP code is missing 2016 returns, so the ZIP-level models carry no 2016 missingness indicator, and the label vector in the analysis script names one anyway. The same vector is reused for all three outcomes, which is also why the 2014 and 2012 covariate rows of Tables F.10 and F.11 read Two Party Vote Share where the regressors are vote margins and vote totals. The 2014 and 2012 rows of Table F.9 are correct as published.

Published, Tables E.7 and F.8, each of the three lagged covariate rows:

> **Two Party Vote Share**

Corrected:

> **Two Party Vote Margin**

Published, Tables F.9, F.10 and F.11, the first covariate row:

> **Missingness Indicator (2016)**

Corrected, respectively:

> **Two Party Vote Share (2016)**, **Two Party Vote Margin (2016)**, **Two Party Vote Total (2016)**

All five tables are reprinted below with corrected labels and otherwise unchanged.

Table E.7: Experimental balance

	Model 1
Intercept	0.553*
	(0.083)
Two Party Vote Margin (2016)	0.000
	(0.000)
Missingness Indicator (2016)	0.083
	(0.158)
Two Party Vote Margin (2014)	-0.000
	(0.000)
Missingness Indicator (2014)	0.096
	(0.080)
Two Party Vote Margin (2012)	-0.000
	(0.000)
Missingness Indicator (2012)	-0.122
	(0.087)
R2	0.035
Num. obs.	1096
N Clusters	169

* $p < 0.05$

CR2 cluster-robust standard errors, clustered by ZIP code, are in parentheses.

Table F.8: Experimental balance (ZIP code level)

	Model 1
Intercept	0.500*
	(0.039)
Two Party Vote Margin (2016)	0.000
	(0.000)
Two Party Vote Margin (2014)	-0.000
	(0.000)
Two Party Vote Margin (2012)	0.000
	(0.000)
R2	0.009
Num. obs.	210

* $p < 0.05$

HC2 robust standard errors are in parentheses.

Table F.9: Effects on vote share (ZIP code level)

	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4
Any Treatment Video	0.0099	0.0015		
	(0.0145)	(0.0088)		
Treatment Video 1			0.0167	0.0055
			(0.0178)	(0.0086)
Treatment Video 2			0.0030	-0.0025
			(0.0181)	(0.0128)
Two Party Vote Share (2016)		0.7451*		0.7449*
		(0.0593)		(0.0592)
Two Party Vote Share (2014)		0.0476*		0.0463
		(0.0235)		(0.0238)
Missingness Indicator (2014)		4.8184*		4.6876*
		(2.3429)		(2.3766)
Two Party Vote Share (2012)		-0.0031		-0.0006
		(0.0444)		(0.0453)
Missingness Indicator (2012)		-0.2794		-0.0337
		(4.4175)		(4.5047)
Intercept	0.4652*	0.1101*	0.4652*	0.1097*
	(0.0099)	(0.0210)	(0.0099)	(0.0209)
R2	0.0022	0.6607	0.0044	0.6614
Num. obs.	210	210	210	210

* $p < 0.05$

HC2 robust standard errors are in parentheses.

Table F.10: Effects on vote margin (ZIP code level)

	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4
Any Treatment Video	68.5920	-77.2672		
	(269.4097)	(156.3489)		
Treatment Video 1			9.3438	-132.2842
			(275.9061)	(177.3083)
Treatment Video 2			127.8401	-23.5587
			(384.5197)	(211.4121)
Two Party Vote Margin (2016)		0.5251*		0.5242*
		(0.0550)		(0.0554)
Two Party Vote Margin (2014)		0.1689*		0.1703*
		(0.0567)		(0.0576)
Missingness Indicator (2014)		-255.9467*		-246.7978
		(113.4945)		(130.5084)
Two Party Vote Margin (2012)		-0.2590*		-0.2587*
		(0.1175)		(0.1173)
Missingness Indicator (2012)		91.8170		112.0516
		(136.4758)		(139.7764)
Intercept	-408.7512*	203.0807	-408.7512*	201.2060
	(183.9857)	(136.3052)	(183.9857)	(136.3445)
R2	0.0003	0.6543	0.0008	0.6547
Num. obs.	210	210	210	210

* $p < 0.05$

HC2 robust standard errors are in parentheses.

Table F.11: Effects on turnout (ZIP code level)

	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4
Any Treatment Video	-89.8289	195.6585		
	(953.4329)	(526.4417)		
Treatment Video 1			-439.0957	1018.5754
			(1125.3363)	(685.7638)
Treatment Video 2			259.4380	-590.5218
			(1182.4407)	(631.3777)
Two Party Vote Total (2016)		0.5533*		0.5594*
		(0.0735)		(0.0716)
Two Party Vote Total (2014)		0.3027*		0.3062*
		(0.0840)		(0.0817)
Missingness Indicator (2014)		-711.4928		-810.5134
		(393.1901)		(664.3380)
Two Party Vote Total (2012)		-0.4790*		-0.4852*
		(0.1361)		(0.1344)
Missingness Indicator (2012)		-1718.2381*		-1990.3628*
		(865.2703)		(924.3390)
Intercept	7811.4898*	2332.4258*	7811.4898*	2292.1032*
	(701.0554)	(1138.7188)	(701.0554)	(1112.1093)
R2	0.0000	0.6781	0.0013	0.6848
Num. obs.	210	210	210	210

* $p < 0.05$

HC2 robust standard errors are in parentheses.

Note: Tables E.7, F.8, F.9, F.10 and F.11 as published, with covariate row labels corrected. Every coefficient, standard error and summary statistic is unchanged. Estimated from the deposited replication archive by the correspondingly named scripts under `maintained/`.

4. Appendix Table B.3 reprints Table B.4

Table B.3 is captioned "Effects on vote share (CD fixed effects)." Every cell beneath that caption is identical to Table B.4, "Effects on vote margin (CD fixed effects)": the same coefficients, standard errors, R-squared values and covariate labels, all on the vote margin scale. The vote share models with congressional district fixed effects appear nowhere in the appendix.

Those models are estimable from the deposited data, and this edition prints them in place of the duplicated table. The effect of any treatment video on vote share with district fixed effects is 0.0042 (0.0217) without covariates, the same substantive result as Table 4. The table that should have appeared:

Table B.3: Effects on vote share (CD fixed effects)

	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4
Any Treatment Video	0.0042	-0.0018		
	(0.0217)	(0.0088)		
Treatment Video 1			-0.0154	-0.0039
			(0.0244)	(0.0116)
Treatment Video 2			0.0235	0.0001
			(0.0272)	(0.0099)
Two Party Vote Share (2016)		0.8606*		0.8608*
		(0.0650)		(0.0658)
Missingness Indicator (2016)		85.5648*		85.5856*
		(6.4709)		(6.5436)
Two Party Vote Share (2014)		0.1287*		0.1275*
		(0.0577)		(0.0595)
Missingness Indicator (2014)		12.8016*		12.6841*
		(5.7405)		(5.9197)
Two Party Vote Share (2012)		0.0548		0.0544
		(0.0301)		(0.0306)
Missingness Indicator (2012)		5.4696		5.4254
		(2.9908)		(3.0440)
Intercept	0.4805*	0.0083	0.4789*	0.0088
	(0.0228)	(0.0123)	(0.0228)	(0.0127)
R2	0.04	0.84	0.05	0.84
Num. obs.	853	853	853	853
N Clusters	154	154	154	154

* $p < 0.05$

CR2 cluster-robust standard errors are in parentheses.

All models include fixed effects for congressional district.

Note: Estimated from the deposited replication archive by `maintained/table_b3_vote_share_precinct_cd.R`, which fits the vote share models with congressional district fixed effects that Table B.3 was captioned for. Standard errors in parentheses; $*$ denotes $p < 0.05$.

Table 2

The three entries below were found by setting Table 2 from the authors' own source for the remastered edition, which meant reading every cell against the published page. The source is correct in each case: the errors entered when the publisher re-set the table.

5. Table 2 prints three words the advertisement does not contain

Published, p. 4:

> Trump audio: “We’re getting rid of gun-free **on lock down** zones’

Corrected:

> Trump audio: “We’re getting rid of gun-free zones’

The words migrated in from the adjacent cell, which reads “they’re putting us on lock down” two lines above. Confirmed three ways: the extracted words sit at x 0.1030 to 0.2308, inside the left column and at its own continuation indent; the region renders and reads that way at 200 dpi; and the authors’ own source sets the cell as “gun-free zones”. The advertisement’s line is “gun-free zones”.

6. A colon in Table 2 has lost the space after it

Published, p. 4:

> On-screen text **messages:Mom.** I’m in social studies

Corrected:

> On-screen text messages: Mom. I’m in social studies

The authors’ source sets the label and the message as separate cells.

7. A sentence in Table 2 has lost its full stop

Published, p. 4:

> I wish you were **here**

Corrected:

> I wish you were here.

Every other line of the transcript ends in its own punctuation.

The reference list

The nine entries below correct the article's reference list. Each was found by an audit that sends every printed entry whole to Crossref and checks the authoritative record back into it, and each is verified against the record named in its note. None affects a citation in the text, and no cited work is missing or misattributed in the body of the article: the errors are in how the reference list prints the works, and nearly all of them entered through the publisher's reference processing rather than through the manuscript.

8. Seven authors of Bond et al. (2012) are mangled in the reference list

Published, p. 7:

> Bond RM, Fariss CJ, **JonesJonesKramer JJ**, et al. (2012) **Cameron Marlow, Jaime E. Settle and James H. Fowler**A 61-million-person experiment

Corrected:

> Bond RM, Fariss CJ, Jones JJ, Kramer ADI, et al. (2012) A 61-million-person experiment

Three surnames were run together and four more authors were carried into the title. Crossref, doi 10.1038/nature11421: Bond, Fariss, Jones, Kramer, Marlow, Settle, Fowler.

9. Coppock, Hill and Vavreck (2020) is given the wrong third author and the wrong title

Published, p. 7:

> Coppock A, Hill SJ and **Lynn V** (2020) **Persuasive Effects of Presidential Campaign Advertising: Results of 53 Real-Time Experiments in 2016. Science Advances.**

Corrected:

> Coppock A, Hill SJ and Vavreck L (2020) The small effects of political advertising are small regardless of context, message, sender, or receiver: Evidence from 59 real-time randomized experiments. Science Advances 6(36): eabc4046.

Lynn Vavreck's given name was taken for her surname, and the title is the working paper's rather than the published article's; the entry carried no volume or article number. Crossref, doi 10.1126/sciadv.abc4046.

10. Two authors of Fowler et al. (2021) are run together

Published, p. 7:

Fowler EF, **FranzMartin MM, Gregory J**, et al. (2021)

Corrected:

Fowler EF, Franz MM, Martin GJ, et al. (2021)

Crossref, doi 10.1017/S0003055420000696: Fowler, Franz, Martin, Peskowitz, Ridout.

11. The third author of Turitto et al. (2014) is given by his first name

Published, p. 7:

Turitto C, Green DP, **Brian S**, et al. (2014)

Corrected:

Turitto C, Green DP, Stobie B, et al. (2014)

Crossref, doi 10.2139/ssrn.3537287: Turitto, Green, Stobie, Tranter.

12. Spenkuch and Toniatti (2018) lists its second author twice

Published, p. 7:

Spenkuch JL, **Toniatti D and Toniatti D** (2018)

Corrected:

Spenkuch JL and Toniatti D (2018)

Crossref, doi 10.1093/qje/qjy010: two authors.

13. Moore (2012) prints its page range without a dash

Published, p. 7:

Political Analysis **20(4): 460479**

Corrected:

Political Analysis 20(4): 460–479

Crossref, doi 10.1093/pan/mps025: pages 460–479.

14. The Wesleyan Media Project's name is inverted

Published, p. 7:

> **Media Project Wesleyan** (2021)

Corrected:

> Wesleyan Media Project (2021)

The organization is the Wesleyan Media Project, as its own address (mediaproject.wesleyan.edu) gives it; the reference processor read "Wesleyan" as a given name.

15. A stray comma inside an author name

Published, p. 7:

> Coppock A, Guess A and **Ternovski, J** (2016)

Corrected:

> Coppock A, Guess A and Ternovski J (2016)

16. Green and Gerber (2019) is given the wrong place of publication

Published, p. 7:

> **New York, NY:** Brookings Institution Press

Corrected:

> Washington, DC: Brookings Institution Press

Brookings Institution Press is in Washington, DC.

The reference list, read against the page

The two entries below are errors in the printed reference list that the Crossref audit cannot see, because it compares authors, titles and venues rather than line breaks and URLs. Both were found by reading the published page.

17. A line break in the Goldmacher and Bui (2019) title is printed as a capitalised word

Published, p. 7:

> What the 2020 **Candi- Dates**' Campaign Spending Reveals

Corrected:

> What the 2020 **Candidates**' Campaign Spending Reveals

"Candi-" and "Dates" are one word broken across a line, and the second half was then title-cased as though it were a word of its own. The New York Times headline reads "Candidates".

18. Three reference URLs are printed with a space in them, so as printed they do not resolve

Published, p. 7:

> …/trump-digital-director-**brad- parscale**-facebook-advertising; …/democrats-**political-facebook**-ads.html; …/papers.cfm?**abstract id**=3537287

Corrected:

> …/trump-digital-director-**brad-parscale**-facebook-advertising; …/democrats-**political-facebook**-ads.html; …/papers.cfm?**abstract_id**=3537287

Beckett (2017), Goldmacher and Bui (2019) and Turitto et al. (2014). The first two carry a space where the URL was broken across a line; the third has lost its underscore. The corrected Guardian URL resolves; the New York Times and SSRN addresses refuse automated requests and resolve in the Internet Archive.